CURRICULUM ALIGNMENT GUIDE · MAY 2026

Swim & Water Safety
Australian Curriculum Alignment

A guide for teachers outside Victoria to understand, adapt, and use this resource suite — mapped to Australian Curriculum Version 9.0 HPE (Years 7–8 and 9–10).

Australian Curriculum V9.0 | Years 7–8 & 9–10 | Health & Physical Education | Dryland · Classroom-based | 51 resources

01 Context — What This Suite Is and Where It Came From

This resource suite was developed collaboratively by an HPE teacher and educational designer to address a gap in readily available, classroom-ready, dryland swimming and water safety teaching resources. The 51 resources in the suite cover Years 7–8 and Years 9–10 and require no pool access to deliver — everything is designed for a standard classroom or gymnasium setting.

The suite was originally developed against the **Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0** (VCAA), specifically the Health and Physical Education learning area and its safety focus area. It draws on resources and research from Lifesaving Victoria (LSV), Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA), Surf Life Saving Australia (SLSA), AUSTSWIM, Paddle Australia, and international bodies including RLSS UK and the CDC.

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IMPORTANT DISTINCTION FOR NON-VICTORIAN TEACHERS

The Victorian Curriculum V2.0 is VCAA's adaptation of the Australian Curriculum V9.0 — they are related but not identical. Strand names, content description codes (VC2HP8P / VC2HP8M vs AC9HP8P / AC9HP8M), and some focus area boundaries differ. This document maps the suite directly to Australian Curriculum V9.0 codes so teachers in all other states and territories can use it confidently.

The core pedagogical approach is consistent with Australian Curriculum HPE principles: a strength-based, inquiry-oriented approach to health literacy; analysis of risk and health information; and movement skill development in authentic contexts. The content is highly transferable across jurisdictions.

02 Australian Curriculum V9.0 — State & Territory Adoption

All Australian states and territories are required to adopt Australian Curriculum V9.0. Timelines and adaptation approaches differ. The table below gives a current-as-of-2026 summary so you can judge how directly the AC9HP codes in this document apply to your school.

Queensland

QCAA — unmodified AC

✔ AC V9 — Staged rollout 2024–2028

Queensland implements the Australian Curriculum as written, with no state adaptation. AC9HP codes used in this document apply directly. QCAA resources and standard elaborations are fully compatible.

Australian Capital Territory

ACT Education

✔ AC V9 — Implemented from 2024

ACT adopts the Australian Curriculum directly. AC9HP codes used in this document apply without modification. Full implementation required from 2024.

Tasmania

TASC / DoE Tasmania

✔ AC V9 — Implemented from 2023

Tasmania was among the earliest adopters of V9 in government schools. AC9HP codes apply directly. Some independent schools may still be in transition.

South Australia

DECD / SA Education

✔ AC V9 — All schools required from 2024

All SA school sectors (government, Catholic, independent) are required to implement AC V9.0. AC9HP codes apply directly.

Northern Territory

NT Department of Education

✔ AC V9 — Implementation underway

NT implements AC V9.0 with full adoption required. AC9HP codes apply directly. Note: NT has significant Indigenous community contexts — see localisation guidance in Section 5.

New South Wales

NESA — adopt & adapt

→ Adapting V9 into NSW syllabuses

NESA uses an 'adopt and adapt' approach — AC content is incorporated into NSW syllabuses with local additions. New HPE syllabuses aligned to V9 are in development. In the interim, check NESA PDHPE syllabuses for alignment. Core content descriptions are highly compatible.

Western Australia

SCSA — adopt & adapt

→ HPE mandated from 2025

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WA has adapted V9 into the Western Australian Curriculum for HPE, mandated from 2025. The WA adaptation is closely aligned to AC V9.0 HPE content descriptions. Verify codes against SCSA's curriculum browser for exact WA code equivalents.

FOR NSW AND WA TEACHERS

Even where your jurisdiction uses adapted syllabuses rather than direct AC codes, the content descriptions in this resource suite align to the same underlying concepts — risk assessment, protective behaviours, health information analysis, and movement in aquatic contexts. Cross-reference the AC9HP codes below with your syllabus content descriptions; the match will be evident at the concept level even if codes differ.

03 Australian Curriculum V9.0 Content Description Alignment

The table below maps each major theme and resource cluster in the Swim & Water Safety suite against Australian Curriculum V9.0 HPE content descriptions for Years 7–8 (codes prefixed **AC9HP8**) and Years 9–10 (codes prefixed **AC9HP10**). Alignment strength is rated for each match.

STRAND KEY

Codes ending in **P** = Personal, social and community health strand. Codes ending in **M** = Movement and physical activity strand. Both strands must be taught in every year level per AC requirements.

Years 7–8 Alignment

THEME / RESOURCE CLUSTER	AC V9.0 CODE	CONTENT DESCRIPTION (ABBREVIATED)	A
Water hazard identification & risk assessment Lessons 1–2, Workbook Sec 1–2, Scenario Cards	AC9HP8P10	Plan and implement strategies, using health resources, to enhance health, safety, relationships and wellbeing	●
Drowning statistics analysis & data tasks Data Analysis PDF, Lesson 2, Quiz Bank	AC9HP8P09	Investigate how media and influential people impact attitudes, beliefs, decisions and behaviours in relation to health, safety and wellbeing	●
Protective behaviours & help-seeking Lesson 3, Workbook Sec 3, DRS ABCD resources	AC9HP8P08	Refine protective behaviours and evaluate community resources to seek help for themselves and others	●
Emergency response — DRS ABCD, CPR, call 000 Lesson 4, Emergency Response resources	AC9HP8P08	Refine protective behaviours and evaluate community resources to seek help	●
Peer influence, risk-taking behaviour & decision-making Lesson 3, Decision-making scenarios, Debate Framework	AC9HP8P06	Analyse factors that influence emotional responses and devise strategies to self-manage emotions	◗
Media analysis — water safety campaigns Lesson 5, Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit	AC9HP8P09	Investigate how media and influential people impact attitudes, beliefs, decisions and behaviours in relation to health, safety and wellbeing	●
Survival float, HELP position, dryland movement simulation Lesson 4–5, Movement resources	AC9HP8M01	Analyse, refine and transfer movement skills in a variety of movement situations	●
Reach & throw rescue techniques (dryland) Lesson 4, Rescue Simulation activities	AC9HP8M01 AC9HP8M07	Analyse, refine and transfer movement skills / Propose and evaluate movement strategies most effective in different situations	●

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THEME / RESOURCE CLUSTER	AC V9.0 CODE	CONTENT DESCRIPTION (ABBREVIATED)	A
Water environments & community use of outdoor spaces Lesson 1, BeachSafe activities, local waterway tasks	AC9HP8M05	Participate in activities that utilise community spaces and outdoor settings; evaluate strategies to support increased use	◗
Personal fitness for aquatic environments Lesson 5, Fitness activities	AC9HP8M04	Participate in activities to investigate the impact of regular participation on health, fitness and wellbeing	◗
Inclusion in aquatic activities & fair play Differentiated workbooks, EAL/D scaffold, teacher notes	AC9HP8M08 AC9HP8M09	Investigate modifications supporting fair play and inclusive participation / Leadership, collaboration, group decision-making	◗
Student health action plans Assessment task, Digital Portfolio template	AC9HP8P10	Plan and implement strategies, using health resources, to enhance their own and others' health, safety and wellbeing	●

Years 9–10 Alignment

The advanced Year 9–10 resources in the suite (Advanced Workbook, Extension and Scaffolded versions, Data Pack, Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit) extend into deeper analysis, public health advocacy, and complex scenario reasoning — well aligned to the Years 9–10 band.

THEME / RESOURCE CLUSTER	AC V9.0 CODE	CONTENT DESCRIPTION (ABBREVIATED)	A
Social determinants of drowning; health equity analysis Advanced Workbook Sec 5–6, Extension tasks	AC9HP10P09	Examine the extent to which health information and digital environments influence health decisions and behaviours	●
Water safety policy & public health advocacy Extension tasks, Debate Framework, Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit	AC9HP10P10	Design, implement and evaluate strategies for health, safety, relationships and wellbeing using health resources	●

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THEME / RESOURCE CLUSTER	AC V9.0 CODE	CONTENT DESCRIPTION (ABBREVIATED)	A
Critical analysis of drowning risk data Data Pack, Advanced Workbook Sec 3–4	AC9HP10P09	Examine health information and digital environments influencing health decisions	●
Advanced rescue & lifesaving movement — Bronze concepts Advanced Workbook Sec 6, Movement resources	AC9HP10M01	Refine, apply and transfer movement skills to achieve movement outcomes	●
Leadership in aquatic safety scenarios Scenario Cards, Debate Framework, group decision-making tasks	AC9HP10M09	Apply leadership, collaboration and decision-making processes across physical activity contexts	●
Wellbeing strategies for active aquatic participation Advanced Workbook, Fitness integration tasks	AC9HP10M06	Design and evaluate strategies to achieve health and wellbeing outcomes	◗

ALSO RELEVANT — GENERAL CAPABILITIES

The suite explicitly develops several AC General Capabilities across resources: **CRITICAL AND CREATIVE THINKING** (data analysis, scenario reasoning); **LITERACY** (reading health information, persuasive writing, media analysis); **NUMERACY** (drowning statistics, risk calculation); **PERSONAL AND SOCIAL CAPABILITY** (protective behaviours, help-seeking); and **INTERCULTURAL UNDERSTANDING** (CALD community risk data, multilingual parent resources). These are embedded throughout and do not require separate mapping.

04

Resource Suite Overview

The full suite contains 77+ individual resources. Below is a summary of the major resource types, their audience, and their primary AC alignment. All resources are available as HTML files; major resources are also available as PDF. PowerPoint decks are available for key lessons.

STUDENT · YEAR 7–8

Student Workbook (5-lesson unit)

Core classroom resource covering all five lessons. Available as HTML, print-optimised HTML, and PDF. Includes activities, reflection prompts, and knowledge checks.

AC9HP8P08 AC9HP8P09 AC9HP8P10 AC9HP8M01

TEACHER · YEAR 7–8

Teacher Resource Guide

Full lesson plans with timing, teaching notes, differentiation strategies, answer key, and assessment rubric. HTML and PDF.

All Y7–8 codes Vic Curriculum Adaptable

STUDENT · YEAR 7–8 · DIFFERENTIATED

Scaffolded Workbook (EAL/D & adjusted)

Simplified language, sentence starters, visual supports. Designed for EAL/D learners and students requiring additional scaffolding. HTML and PDF.

AC9HP8P08 AC9HP8P10 EAL/D focus

STUDENT · YEAR 7–8 · DIFFERENTIATED

Extension Workbook (deeper inquiry)

Higher-order analysis tasks, extended writing, research extensions. HTML and PDF.

AC9HP8P09 AC9HP8P10 Critical thinking

STUDENT · YEAR 9–10

Advanced Workbook (6-section unit)

Deeper engagement with water safety as a public health issue, social determinants, advocacy and leadership. HTML and PDF.

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AC9HP10P09 AC9HP10P10 AC9HP10M01

ASSESSMENT · YEAR 7–8 & 9–10

Quiz Question Bank (PDF)

Formative and summative quiz questions across all five lessons. Multiple choice, short answer, and scenario-based. Editable format.

Formative Summative

CLASSROOM RESOURCE

Myths & Facts Poster

A2-format poster debunking common water safety myths. Printable HTML. Useful as a lesson hook or classroom display.

AC9HP8P09 Display

CLASSROOM RESOURCE

Debate Framework

Structured framework for student debate on water safety policy questions. Develops critical thinking, communication, and health advocacy skills.

AC9HP10P10 AC9HP10M09

DATA RESOURCE · YEAR 9–10

Drowning Data Analysis Pack

Structured data analysis tasks using Australian drowning statistics. Cross-curricular links to Mathematics (data/statistics). PDF.

AC9HP10P09 Numeracy

CLASSROOM RESOURCE

Scenario Cards

Decision-making scenario cards for group activities across multiple lesson topics. Covers beach, river, pool, and flood environments.

AC9HP8P08 AC9HP8M07

TEACHER · SUBSTITUTE / RELIEF

Substitute Teacher Pack

Self-contained lesson for relief teachers. Requires no prior knowledge of the unit. Instructions, activity, and assessment built in.

Standalone | Relief-ready

FAMILY / COMMUNITY

Parent/Family Information Sheet

Available in English, Simplified Chinese, Hindi, and Burmese. Explains the unit, key safety messages, and local resources.

Multilingual | Localisation needed

TEACHER · ADMINISTRATION

Excursion Risk Management Template

Risk management documentation template for aquatic excursions. References Victorian legislative requirements — **requires localisation for non-Victorian use**.

Vic-specific | Must localise

STUDENT · DIGITAL

Student Digital Portfolio Template

Structured digital portfolio template for students to document and reflect on learning across the unit. HTML-based with guided prompts.

AC9HP8P10 | Reflective

PRESENTATION

PowerPoint Decks (×2)

Teacher-facing presentation decks for Year 7–8 and Year 9–10 units. Include lesson outlines, discussion prompts, and embedded statistics.

Y7–8 | Y9–10

REFERENCE · INDEX

Glossary of Terms & Acronyms

Comprehensive interactive HTML glossary covering all curriculum, medical, water safety, and organisational terms used across the suite.

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Reference Students & teachers

05 Localisation Guidance — Adapting for Your State or Territory

The vast majority of content in this suite is directly transferable across Australia. The pedagogical approach, health literacy framework, curriculum alignment, and most of the lesson content require no modification. However, a small number of elements reference Victorian-specific organisations, legislation, or statistics. The table below guides you on what to keep, what to swap, and what to check.

ELEMENT IN RESOURCES	ACTION	REPLACEMENT / GUIDANCE
Lifesaving Victoria (LSV) References to LSV data, Toolkit resources, LSV branding	Swap	Replace with your state's relevant body: • NSW/ACT: **Surf Life Saving NSW** (slsnsw.com.au) / **Royal Life Saving NSW** • QLD: **Surf Life Saving QLD** (lifesaving.com.au) • WA: **Surf Life Saving WA** (surflifesavingwa.com.au) • SA: **Surf Life Saving SA** (surflifesavingsa.com.au) • TAS: **Surf Life Saving Tasmania** • NT: **Royal Life Saving NT** (royallifesaving.com.au)
Victorian drowning statistics LSV annual drowning reports, Victorian data	Swap	Use **Royal Life Saving Australia**'s national drowning reports (royallifesaving.com.au) — these include state-by-state breakdowns. Filter to your state's figures. RLSSA publishes an annual National Drowning Report (free, publicly available).
Victorian aquatic environments Port Phillip Bay, Murray River, Yarra River references	Swap	Substitute local waterway names relevant to your students. The BeachSafe app and website (beachsafe.org.au) covers all Australian coastal locations. Inland waterway safety advice from RLSSA applies nationally.
BeachSafe app references	Keep	BeachSafe (beachsafe.org.au) is a national resource — works for all coastal states and territories. Keep as-is.
Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA)	Keep	RLSSA is a national body. All references, resources, and links remain valid for all states and territories.

ELEMENT IN RESOURCES	ACTION	REPLACEMENT / GUIDANCE
Surf Life Saving Australia (SLSA)	Keep	SLSA is a national body. All references remain valid. Use alongside your state SLS organisation.
AUSTSWIM, Paddle Australia, Swim Australia	Keep	All national bodies. Keep as-is. Swim Australia recently merged with Swimming Australia — check for any URL changes.
Victorian pool fencing legislation Excursion Risk Management Template references	Swap	Replace with your state's relevant legislation. All states require four-sided pool fencing for new installations under the Building Code of Australia, but state regulations vary. Check your state's fair trading or building authority website for current requirements.
Victorian Curriculum codes (VC2HP8P, VC2HP8M, VC2HP10P, VC2HP10M) Appear in workbook footers, teacher guide, assessments (Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0)	Swap	Replace with the AC V9.0 codes from Section 3 of this document. If you're in NSW or WA, additionally map to your state syllabus codes. The curriculum code mapping table (Section 3) gives you the direct equivalents.
Parent information sheet	Check	Content is nationally relevant. Update any references to Victorian-specific organisations or helpline numbers with state equivalents. Multilingual versions (Chinese, Hindi, Burmese) are appropriate for most major Australian cities — verify language priorities for your school community.
DRS ABCD, CPR, 000 emergency protocols	Keep	These are national standards (Australian Resuscitation Council). All content is directly applicable in all states and territories.
First Nations / Acknowledgement of Country Where included in resources	Swap	Update to your local Traditional Custodians. Narragunnawali (narragunnawali.org.au) provides correct Acknowledgements by postcode. This is important for any resource displayed publicly or distributed to students and families.
DFE / DEECD / Victorian Department references	Swap	Replace with your state Department of Education equivalent where they appear (mainly in teacher guide policy sections).

EFFORT ESTIMATE FOR LOCALISATION

For most resources in the suite — particularly student-facing workbooks, scenario cards, the quiz bank, and classroom resources —
NO LOCALISATION IS REQUIRED
. The content, pedagogy, and AC alignment are directly applicable. Localisation effort is mainly concentrated in the teacher guide (policy references), excursion risk management template, parent sheet, and any footers displaying Victorian Curriculum codes.

06 How to Use This Suite in Your School

Getting started — four steps

1. **Download the suite** from the GitHub repository or shared drive link provided by the resource creators.
2. **Review the Unit Overview document** (water_safety_unit_overview.html) — this gives you a complete map of all 51 resources, what order they go in, and where assessment sits.
3. **Check the localisation table above** (Section 5) and make any necessary swaps before distributing to students.
4. **Start with the Teacher Resource Guide** — it gives you the full lesson plan with timing, differentiation, and assessment guidance built in.

Delivery models

The suite is designed for three delivery contexts — all without pool access:

- **5-week unit (Years 7–8):** One 50–60 min lesson per week. Use Student Workbook, Teacher Guide, Scenario Cards, and assessment task.
- **Full-term subject:** Extend with the Advanced Workbook (Y9–10), Data Pack, Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit, and Debate Framework.
- **Single-lesson standalone:** The Substitute Teacher Pack is self-contained and requires no prior unit context.

Curriculum planning documentation

When writing your unit plan, use the AC V9.0 codes from Section 3 of this document. For Queensland teachers, the QCAA standard elaborations for Years 7–8 HPE are directly compatible. For WA, cross-reference with SCSA's curriculum browser using the content description text — the WA adaptation closely mirrors the AC descriptions.

Assessment

The suite includes formative assessment (quiz question bank, workbook activities, exit tickets) and summative assessment (student action plan, portfolio template, extended response rubric). Assessment tasks can be used as-is or modified — all are criterion-referenced and include teacher rubrics.

> **CONTACT AND FEEDBACK**
>
> This resource suite was developed by Emilie Harrison (HPE teacher). For questions about adapting resources for your school context, or to provide feedback, contact via the resource index page or the GitHub repository.

Swim & Water Safety Teaching Resource Suite — Australian Curriculum Alignment Guide
Developed by Emilie Harrison · May 2026 · For HPE teachers across Australia

v9.australiancurriculum.edu.au
royallifesaving.com.au
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